

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

EVALUATOR:

DATE:

PRODUCT:

TASK:

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

The login page does not provide visible feedback when users press the Login button.

The loading screen only shows animated dots without indicating loading progress or estimated waiting time.

Users are not informed whether entered credentials are being validated.

Recommendations

Add loading indicators such as “Signing in...” after pressing the login button.

Display progress feedback during loading and account setup processes.

Use success and error notifications immediately after user actions.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

Some technical labels such as “Business Setup” and “Business Type” may not clearly explain their purpose to first-time users.

The onboarding instructions are minimal and may not fully guide non-technical users.

Recommendations

Use simpler and more familiar language for financial tasks.

Add short explanations or examples below form fields.

Include user-friendly onboarding descriptions and contextual guidance.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Some setup screens provide limited exit or cancellation options. Users may accidentally proceed without easy recovery options.

The onboarding flow lacks a clearly visible "Skip All" or "Return to Previous Step" option in some screens.

Recommendations

Add clear back, cancel, and exit buttons on every setup screen. Allow users to save progress and continue later.

Provide confirmation dialogs before leaving unfinished forms.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

Button styles and spacing appear inconsistent across some screens.

Some icons and input field layouts differ between onboarding and login sections.

Navigation behavior changes between screens.

Recommendations

Standardize button colors, sizes, typography, and spacing throughout the application.

Use consistent icon styles and navigation patterns.

Follow common mobile banking application conventions.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

The login form does not visibly indicate password requirements or formatting rules.

There is limited validation feedback before submission.

Phone number and email fields may accept incorrect formats without guidance.

Recommendations

Add real-time validation for email, password, and phone number fields.

Prevent invalid submissions by disabling buttons until required fields are completed properly.

Provide field examples and formatting hints.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

Users must remember account requirements without visible assistance.

Password visibility toggle is small and may be overlooked.

Some onboarding information disappears after moving to the next screen.

Recommendations

Keep important instructions visible while filling forms.

Add placeholder examples and helper text.

Improve visibility of password show/hide controls and remembered credentials.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The login page lacks alternative quick login methods beyond Google and Apple.

No biometric login option is shown.

Returning users cannot customize shortcuts or preferred sign-in methods.

Recommendations

Add biometric authentication such as fingerprint or face recognition.

Allow users to save preferred login methods.

Include autofill and smart suggestions for faster sign-in.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

Some screens contain excessive empty space that reduces information efficiency.

The onboarding slides are visually simple but lack engaging content.

Certain elements appear oversized relative to the content.

Recommendations

Improve visual balance and spacing consistency.

Add concise illustrations or feature highlights during onboarding.

Reduce unnecessary whitespace while maintaining readability.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

Error messages are not clearly visible in the provided login screens.

Users may not understand why login attempts fail.

Recovery instructions are limited.

Recommendations

Use clear error messages in red text with specific explanations.

Suggest corrective actions such as “Incorrect password. Try again or reset password.”

Improve visibility of “Forgot Password” recovery steps.

10

Help and Documentation

It’s best if the system doesn’t need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The login and onboarding process lack visible help or tutorial support.

First-time users may struggle to understand account setup requirements.

Recommendations

Add onboarding tutorials and contextual help icons.

Provide FAQs and support links directly on login and setup screens.

Include guided walkthroughs for business account setup.